

Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. During what Japanese festival do the spirits of deceased family members return to receive ritual offerings of food made by their loved ones?
 - (a) Obon
 - (b) Mikoshi
 - (c) Omizutori
 - (d) Tanabata
2. What does the phrase Guru-Panth mean within the Sikh traditions?
 - (a) Community
 - (b) Scripture
 - (c) Worship
 - (d) Apprenticeship
3. Which of the following does the Qur'an permit?
 - (a) Honor Killing
 - (b) Stoning
 - (c) Adultery
 - (d) Polygyny
4. Who is the eighth-century CE female poet worshipped throughout many South Indian temples dedicated to Vishnu?
 - (a) Andal
 - (b) Devi
 - (c) Ganga
 - (d) Kali
5. Which mystic believed that evil was a distortion that reveals divine love more clearly?
 - (a) Julian of Norwich
 - (b) Catherine of Siena
 - (c) Teresa of Avila
 - (d) John of the Cross

True / False (10 marks)

Answer True or False

6. True or False: The philosopher Laozi is primarily associated with Daoism, a tradition that emphasizes living in harmony with the Dao.
7. True or False: The term xin refers to the idea of piety, focusing on religious devotion and duty in various cultures.
8. True or False: The concept of 'Kama' in dharma texts denotes the four stages of life.
9. True or False: Sri Lakshmi is the goddess worshipped during the festival of Divali, symbolizing wealth and prosperity.
10. True or False: The Rabbinical period in Judaism began after the destruction of the Second Temple in 70 CE.

Long Form Response (20 marks)

Answer each question with a clear and complete explanation.

11. Discuss the beliefs and motivations of Aum Shinrikyo, particularly how their views on cleansing Japanese society through apocalyptic events reflect broader themes in religious movements.
12. Discuss the contributions of Honen to the development of Pure Land Buddhism, and analyze how his teachings have influenced contemporary Buddhist practices.

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